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Russia Exports Combat-Proven Orlan-10E Drone for Artillery Correction

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Russia Exports Combat-Proven Orlan-10E Drone for Artillery Correction.

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Russia is showcasing the Orlan-10E as an export-ready version of its widely used battlefield reconnaissance drone, signaling a combat-proven capability available to foreign operators. Its relevance lies in its demonstrated ability to support targeting, surveillance, and artillery correction in contested environments, making it a force multiplier for modern land operations.

The system emphasizes long endurance and flexible deployment, enabling persistent intelligence gathering and rapid adaptation across front-line missions. This aligns with broader trends in drone-led warfare, where affordable, resilient ISR platforms enhance situational awareness and improve strike accuracy under electronic warfare pressure.

Related Topic: [Russia presents Orlan-10E at WDS 2024 in Saudi Arabia](#)



The Orlan-10E operates at altitudes of up to 5,000 meters above sea level, which provides a degree of separation from short-range air defense threats. (Picture source: Army Recognition)

The Orlan-10 remains the most widely used reconnaissance drone within Russian forces, and the export version, Orlan-10E, follows a similar architecture adapted for international customers. The manufacturer indicates that this display marks the first public appearance of the drone with this specific airbrushed design. The system is part of the Russian export portfolio managed by Rosoboronexport, an entity within the Rostec group, reflecting its positioning for foreign markets.

Displayed at the Defence Services Asia 2026 exhibition in Kuala Lumpur, the drone is presented within the unified Russian pavilion. The event, held from 20 to 23 April, serves as a platform for defense industry actors to showcase equipment to institutional and government buyers. In this context, the Orlan-10E is positioned as a tactical reconnaissance system with prior operational use.

From a technical perspective, the Orlan-10E features compact dimensions, with a length of approximately 200 cm, a height of 60 cm, and a wingspan ranging between 320 and 380 cm. This configuration supports a balance between low observability, lift capacity, and ease of transport. With a maximum takeoff weight of 18.6 kg, the drone can be deployed by tactical units without requiring significant infrastructure.

The system uses an internal combustion engine powered by a gasoline-oil mixture, a configuration that prioritizes endurance and logistical simplicity in field conditions. This propulsion allows a maximum endurance of up to 10 hours, suitable for extended surveillance missions. The maximum horizontal speed is stated at 100 km/h, enabling coverage of wide areas while maintaining stable conditions for onboard sensors.



The Orlan-10E operates at altitudes of up to 5,000 meters above sea level, which provides a degree of separation from short-range air defense threats. Its data link range reaches 120 km, defining the maximum distance for real-time control from the ground station. In addition, the system's total operational range can extend up to 1,000 km depending on the mission profile, particularly when operating in semi-autonomous flight modes.

Launch is performed via a catapult, removing the need for a runway and enabling rapid deployment in austere environments. Recovery is conducted using a parachute system, which reduces landing constraints and supports reuse under varied operational conditions. The drone supports multiple

flight modes, including automatic and semi-automatic configurations, allowing adjustment of control levels depending on mission requirements.

The drone’s architecture allows integration of intelligence payloads, typically including electro-optical and infrared sensors. These systems support observation in both day and night conditions, with endurance compatible with continuous monitoring missions. In operational use, such a drone can track targets, monitor large areas, and support ground unit coordination through real-time data transmission.

The Special Technology Center, as the designer of the Orlan-10E, follows an industrial approach focused on producing systems that are relatively simple, robust, and suited for broad distribution. The presence of this drone on international markets reflects a wider trend toward the proliferation of tactical unmanned aerial systems. Their accessibility and operational utility contribute to increasing adoption by various actors, influencing capability balances and requiring adjustments in defense doctrines as reconnaissance assets become more widespread.

Written By Erwan Halna du Fretay - Defense Analyst, Army Recognition Group

Erwan Halna du Fretay holds a Master’s degree in International Relations and has experience studying conflicts and global arms transfers. His research interests lie in security and strategic studies, particularly the dynamics of the defense industry, the evolution of military technologies, and the strategic transformation of armed forces.

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